

3. Hard disk clean-up

Run Scandisk and Disk Defragmenter. This will clean up the hard disk for the installation.

4. Run Upgrade Advisor

The Upgrade Advisor is an excellent tool that will test your system's hardware and software compatibility with Windows XP. It is the same tool that runs during the XP Setup, but since you are running it independently, it will give you a report that will help you prepare for the upgrade. It is nearly 32 MB, in size and can be downloaded from www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/pro/howto-buy/upgrading/advisor.asp.

Once you've verified and are satisfied about the compatibility of your hardware and software, you can start the upgrade.

1.7.2 Upgrading to Windows XP

1. Insert the CD-ROM and select "Install Windows XP."
2. Close all running applications such as virus scanners, spyware scanners, etc.
3. Choose an installation type. You can either upgrade or do a clean install. The clean install will either overwrite the existing OS or create a dual-boot system where you can select to either log in to XP or your previous Windows version at system startup. If you're opting for a dual-boot, don't forget to retain your FAT/FAT32 file system. We assume you're opting for an in-place upgrade, so choose "Upgrade (Recommended)" and click next.
4. Accept the license agreement and enter the product key in the next screen.
5. This step duplicates the Upgrade Advisor and verifies the hardware and software compatibility. Review the report and proceed if you are satisfied, else cancel the installation and rectify the problems identified by the Upgrade Advisor.